

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1037

By Hensley

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate the 2026 Mule Day Queen, Ava Grayson Sykes.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should salute those young citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as outstanding Tennesseans of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is Ava Grayson Sykes, who was recently selected as the 2026 Mule Day Court Queen; and

WHEREAS, one of the greatest community events in the State of Tennessee, Mule Day is an annual celebration of all things related to mules and traces its roots back to the 1840s; and

WHEREAS, 2026 Mule Day Queen Ava Sykes is the daughter of Mandy Barry and Josh Sykes, and she is pursuing a degree in social studies with a minor in behavioral management; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Sykes is eager to make an enduring impact in the field of education and is driven by a passion to shape the next generation, leading with her heart, and proving that true leadership begins with service and honoring those who have preceded her; and

WHEREAS, Ava Sykes serves with acumen and alacrity at E.A. Cox Middle School, where she supports students and helps create a positive learning environment; she coaches girls' basketball, teaching her players skills on the court and important life lessons, such as resilience and teamwork; and

WHEREAS, a young woman of many talents and interests, Ms. Sykes enjoys spending quality time with family and friends, serving her community, and cheering on the University of Tennessee football team; and

WHEREAS, Ava Sykes's noteworthy achievement is a tremendous source of pride for her family, her community, and the citizens of Maury County; and

WHEREAS, the Mule Day Queen and her court play a prominent role in the promotion of Mule Day, participating in media interviews and serving as hostesses during the festivities; and

WHEREAS, 2026 Mule Day Queen Ava Sykes epitomizes the spirit of distinction and the commitment to greatness that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; her dedication to excellence is clearly deserving of our respect and admiration; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to pause in our deliberations to acknowledge and applaud this young woman for her remarkable achievement; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Ava Grayson Sykes upon being selected as the 2026 Mule Day Queen, extending to her our best wishes for every future success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.